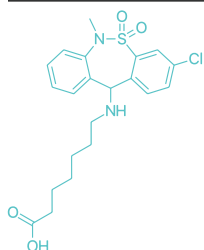


Tianeptine

Quick Guide for People Who Use Drugs



What is Tianeptine?

Tianeptine is an antidepressant with opioid effects. Tianeptine is sold in pills (ZaZa, Tianaa) and powder (Tianeptine sulfate, Tianeptine sodium, or Tianeptine Ethyl Ester).

Uses

Tianeptine has been used to treat depression, anxiety, PTSD, IBS, asthma, fibromyalgia, and ADHD but it is rarely prescribed nowadays due to side effects.

Effects

When used at the prescribed dose, it has light antidepressant effects. In bigger doses, effects can include sedation, muscle relaxation, short-lived euphoria, stimulation, and rapid tolerance build-up. To many, the euphoric effects are felt for about a minute if injecting it.

Side Effects

Most common: headache, dry mouth, dizziness, constipation, insomnia, nightmares, and stomach pain/aches. Uncommon: muscle aches, hot flashes, tremors, palpitations, difficult or painful urination, and blurred vision. Continued use of tianeptine rapidly increases tolerance to opioids like heroin, fentanyl, and morphine. Rash, itching, swelling of the face or tongue, or difficulty breathing can mean that you are allergic to Tianeptine.

Dose

Tianeptine is not a prescription drug in the United States. The prescribed dose in other countries is usually 12.5mg three times a day for anxiety and depression. Recreational or higher doses vary anywhere from 100mg to multiple grams a day with tolerance. Tolerance to tianeptine increases very rapidly with continued use.

Routes of Administration

Tianeptine is a hydrophobic (water insoluble/water hating) drug, meaning it won't easily dissolve in water.

- **It is HIGHLY recommended that this drug only be used orally.** Tianeptine is 99% absorbed by the body when eating it. Unlike other drugs, injecting or snorting tianeptine will not get you higher than eating it. When dissolved in water it turns glue-like and

injecting it may cause vein collapses, vein hiding, vein swelling, and vein hardening **much more frequently** compared with injecting traditional opioids. Injecting Tianeptine pills can cause more harm than injecting tianeptine powder and can result in necrosis (skin rotting) and limb damage (may require amputation) after heavy use. Many stop using tianeptine because after injecting it they can no longer find a vein. Snorting tianeptine is known to be very painful.

Withdrawal

Withdrawal from using 50mg a day for a month can last about a week. Higher doses can make withdrawal more intense and last up to 2 weeks. The most commonly reported adverse effects consist of restless leg syndrome, agitation, nausea, vomiting, increased heart rate, diarrhea, tremors, and excessive sweating. Suicidal thoughts, depression, insomnia, and cold/flu-like symptoms have also been reported with Tianeptine withdrawals.

Withdrawal Management

If tapering off of tianeptine, slowly reduce your dose to avoid withdrawal symptoms. The tianeptine withdrawal is similar to an opioid withdrawal but considered to be harsher for some. The withdrawal symptoms can be managed like opioid withdrawals. Refer to the NEXT opioid detox/withdrawal guide for more information about withdrawal management.

Overdose Prevention

Mixing tianeptine with antidepressants or MAOI drugs can lead to serious cardiovascular (heart) problems. Treat tianeptine like an opioid. Start low and go slow when mixing tianeptine with other depressant drugs like alcohol, opioids, benzos, and alcohol because of the risk of respiratory depression. Try not to use tianeptine alone and have naloxone in-hand in case an overdose occurs. Overdoses have been reported with as little as 300mg of tianeptine.

For more drug-specific information & resources, visit:

www.nextdistro.org/drugspecific

www.nextdistro.org

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